

Q. So, essentially, the trigger is from your own developer community, which identifies these platforms, right?

A. If there are startups that are interested in participating in the Amadeus community and exposing their engineering or functional capabilities to the wider travel industry, then we do have forums for that too. We have a platform called Amadeus Next, which constantly looks at onboarding more startups to use the Amadeus API and Amadeus Sandbox, so that they can play around and create more capabilities for the travel industry. Once it gets more sophisticated, we have our Ventures team driven by the Madrid headquarters, which looks at the network of startups to invest in.

Q. Is there an annual cohort or any other system?

A. Typically, it's a system that is up and running and does not operate in a cohort mode. Startups can make a pitch and we evaluate if they should be connected to our customer base—the airlines, the hotel chains and so on. If there is an appetite, we onboard them and make the connections for the startups to use the Amadeus platform, the APIs, and the sandbox to play in and connect to our customer base.

Q. Can you share any success story of a startup, Indian or global, which has gone through this process and then partnered with you?

A. The partnership between Amadeus and Airportr is a great example of how we support startups in their journey to bring innovative solutions to the travel industry. By partnering with Airportr, a London-based startup that offers luggage pickup and delivery services for air travellers, Amadeus was able to integrate their technology into Amadeus' booking and check-in system, making it possible for passengers to book Airportr's services

at the same time they book their flight.

Through this partnership, Airportr got access to our extensive network of travel industry experts, which helped it to refine its product and expand its reach. Also, our expertise helped it to seamlessly integrate its solution into the booking and check-in process, making it easier for travellers to take advantage of Airportr's services.

Q. Any major platforms other than Kubernetes and the ARIA framework in which Amadeus is an aggressive contributor or driver of the forum, or is leading the communities?

A. We have partnered with Red Hat for OpenStack and OpenShift. Recently, we have also partnered with the Green Software Foundation, which is a foundation created by companies like Accenture, GitHub, Microsoft and ThoughtWorks. The spirit of this foundation is to make sure that all the software is developed in a sustainable way, leaving a minimal carbon footprint in the technology industry. Amadeus is an active participant along with these founding members.

Q. Is IoT also an area of interest for Amadeus and is any work happening there?

A. There are some use cases of IoT, like that of baggage, or where we try to map an airport so that there can be a seamless guiding of passengers to gates. There are solutions that we are working on and experimenting with, like using your mobile phone as a key for the hotel. NFC communication and some level of IoT come into play there too.

Q. And what is your take on the metaverse?

A. A lot of experimentation! It's a cool toy that many companies are experimenting with. We, in the travel industry, are experimenting to see how the metaverse can probably give

a sneak peek of the travel experience before the actual travel. Though we are experimenting, large industry-scale use is yet to happen.

The metaverse is at a stage where we need to wait and watch how it gains traction beyond office productivity into production-grade use. There are some areas where it naturally fits in, like the training of pilots. This is an intense and time-consuming process, and we expect the metaverse to come in and accelerate it. But, ultimately, time will tell.

Q. How about artificial intelligence? Are there any use cases being developed? Or any interesting projects that you can share with us?

A. Everyone wants to know about ChatGPT these days. So yes, we do leverage AI technologies quite intensely within the Amadeus platform. We have some use cases, like how to search the various options that you have to reach from source to destination. If you put London and New York as your source and destination, there could be many options for a traveller. Now, the aim is to use AI and ML techniques to profile the traveller better so that you provide extremely pointed, let's say, 10 options with a high likelihood that the traveller will pick one of them, rather than providing 200 options where the traveller gets lost and doesn't book at all.

We also leverage AI/ML techniques to learn from past travel patterns, demographics, seasonality patterns, and so on to provide more custom solutions. As one example, we are leveraging AI to see how we can troubleshoot the production platform better so that even before a customer reports a problem, we can sense it ourselves and take corrective action.

We are leveraging AI solutions on our customer helpdesk also, to see how quickly we can scan our database of tickets when a customer faces a challenge, so that even before an engineer is asked to get involved, we